

Word family: **damage / damages / damaged / damaging / undamaged / damage control / collateral damage**

Base word: damage

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

- * **damage** (n.) — 損害；破壞；傷害
- * **damage** (v.) — 損害；破壞；傷害
- * **damaged** (adj./participle) — 受損的；被破壞的
- * **damaging** (adj./participle) — 有害的；造成損害的
- * **undamaged** (adj.) — 未受損的；完好的
- * **damages** (plural legal noun) — 損害賠償金
- * **damage control** — 損害控制；危機補救
- * **damage limitation** — 限制損害；減低負面影響
- * **collateral damage** — 附帶損害；附帶傷亡 / 破壞

Major useful extensions:

cause damage, do damage, suffer damage, sustain damage, inflict damage, prevent damage, limit damage, minimise/minimize damage, repair damage, assess damage, severe damage, serious damage, extensive damage, permanent damage, irreversible damage, minor damage, physical damage, structural damage, property damage, water damage, fire damage, storm damage, flood damage, accidental damage, environmental damage, ecological damage, reputational damage, damage to reputation, psychological damage, emotional damage, brain damage, nerve damage, liver damage, tissue damage, damage a relationship, damage trust, damage morale, damage confidence, damage credibility, damage prospects, damage someone's career, damaging evidence, damaging criticism, damaging allegations, professionally damaging, badly damaged, heavily damaged, partially damaged, beyond repair, damage control, damage limitation, collateral damage, claim damages, award damages, pay damages, compensatory damages, punitive damages, nominal damages, liquidated damages, what's the damage?, deal damage, take damage, damage output, damage per second/DPS.

Meaning in this passage

> Such conflict is not only emotionally draining but also professionally **damaging**, because it weakens trust, which is the foundation of all effective teamwork.

Here, **damaging** means:

causing harm to people's professional relationships, trust, effectiveness, reputation, or ability to work well together — 對工作 / 專業關係造成損害的；有害的

The conflict may not physically damage anything. Instead, it harms:

- * trust,
- * cooperation,
- * morale,
- * working relationships,
- * team effectiveness.

****中文翻譯：****

這種衝突不但令人情緒疲憊，在工作層面上也具有****破壞性 / 會造成專業上的損害****，因為它會削弱信任，而信任正是所有有效團隊合作的基礎。

So here:

**professionally damaging = 對工作表現、職場關係或專業處境產生負面影響**

A. DAMAGE = PHYSICAL HARM

1. **damage = physical harm that makes something worse, weaker, or less useful — 損壞；破壞**

The basic noun sense.

Practice 1

> The storm caused serious ****damage**** to the building.

暴風雨對大樓造成嚴重****損壞****。

Practice 2

> The phone showed no visible damage.

手機沒有明顯****損壞****。

Practice 3

> Engineers inspected the damage.

工程師檢查了****受損情況****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****damage = 令物件、建築、設備等變壞、變弱或不能正常使用的損害****

2. **cause damage — 造成損害**

Practice 1

> Heavy rain **caused damage** to several roads.

大雨對數條道路**造成損害**。

Practice 2

> Incorrect use can cause permanent damage.

使用不當可能**造成永久損壞**。

3. **do damage to something — 對.....造成損害**

Practice 1

> Salt water can **do serious damage to metal equipment**.

鹽水可以對金屬設備**造成嚴重損害**。

Practice 2

> The impact did little damage to the vehicle.

撞擊對車輛**造成的損壞不大**。

MCQ-ready definition:

do damage to X = 令 X 受到損害

4. **suffer damage — 遭受損害**

Practice 1

> Several homes **suffered damage** during the storm.

數間房屋在暴風雨中**受到損壞**。

Practice 2

> The equipment suffered only minor damage.

設備只**受到輕微損壞**。

5. **sustain damage — 遭受損害**

Slightly more formal than **suffer damage**.

Practice 1

> The bridge **sustained significant damage**.

大橋**受到嚴重損壞**。

Practice 2

> The aircraft sustained damage to one wing.

飛機其中一邊機翼**受損**。

6. **inflict damage — 造成 / 施加嚴重損害**

Often used when an agent actively causes the harm.

Practice 1

> The attack **inflicted heavy damage** on the facility.

襲擊對設施**造成嚴重破壞**。

Practice 2

> The pest can inflict considerable damage on crops.

這種害蟲可以對農作物**造成相當大的損害**。

B. DEGREE OF DAMAGE

7. **minor damage — 輕微損壞**

Practice 1

> The car suffered only **minor damage**.

汽車只受到**輕微損壞**。

Practice 2

> Minor damage can often be repaired quickly.

輕微損壞通常可以很快修復。

8. **serious / severe damage — 嚴重損害**

Practice 1

> The fire caused **severe damage**.

火災造成**嚴重破壞**。

Practice 2

> The machine could suffer serious damage if it overheats.

機器過熱可能受到**嚴重損壞**。

9. **extensive damage — 大範圍 / 嚴重損壞**

Practice 1

> The building suffered **extensive damage**.

大樓受到**大範圍破壞**。

Practice 2

> Flooding caused extensive damage to farmland.

水浸對農地造成**廣泛損害**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****extensive damage = 影響範圍很大或多個部分受到損壞****

10. ****permanent damage — 永久損害****

Practice 1

> Excessive heat can cause ****permanent damage****.

過熱可以造成****永久損害****。

Practice 2

> Fortunately, there was no permanent damage.

幸好沒有造成****永久性損傷****。

11. ****irreversible damage — 不可逆轉的損害****

Practice 1

> Delaying treatment may cause ****irreversible damage****.

延誤治療可能造成****不可逆轉的損害****。

Practice 2

> Some environmental damage is irreversible.

某些環境破壞是****無法逆轉的****。

12. ****irreparable damage — 無法修復的損害****

Practice 1

> The incident caused ****irreparable damage**** to the historic building.

事件對歷史建築造成****無法修復的破壞****。

Practice 2

> Trust can suffer irreparable damage.

信任可能受到**無法挽回的損害**。

C. TYPES OF PHYSICAL DAMAGE

13. **structural damage — 結構性損壞**

Practice 1

> Engineers found **structural damage** to the building.

工程師發現大樓有**結構性損壞**。

Practice 2

> The earthquake caused serious structural damage.

地震造成嚴重**結構破壞**。

14. **property damage — 財物 / 物業損毀**

Practice 1

> The accident caused substantial **property damage**.

事故造成大量**財物損毀**。

Practice 2

> Insurance may cover property damage.

保險可能涵蓋**物業損害**。

15. **water damage — 水浸 / 水損**

Practice 1

> The ceiling showed signs of **water damage**.

天花板出現**水損 / 滲水損壞**的跡象。

Practice 2

> The documents were ruined by water damage.

文件因**水浸損壞**而報廢。

16. **fire damage — 火災損毀**

Practice 1

> The office was closed because of **fire damage**.

辦公室因**火災損毀**而關閉。

Practice 2

> Inspectors assessed the fire damage.

檢查人員評估了**火災造成的損害**。

17. **storm / flood damage — 風災 / 水災損害**

Practice 1

> Repairs to **storm damage** took several months.

修復**風災損害**花了數個月。

Practice 2

> Farmers received assistance for flood damage.

農民因**水災損失**獲得援助。

18. **accidental damage — 意外損壞**

A common insurance expression.

Practice 1

> The policy includes cover for **accidental damage**.

這份保單包括**意外損壞保障**。

Practice 2

> Accidental damage is different from normal wear and tear.

意外損壞與正常損耗不同。

D. DAMAGE TO THE BODY / HEALTH

19. **damage = injury to body tissue or organs — 身體損傷**

Practice 1

> The accident caused **nerve damage**.

事故造成**神經損傷**。

Practice 2

> Long-term exposure can cause tissue damage.

長期暴露可能造成**組織損傷**。

MCQ-ready definition:

damage = 對身體器官、細胞、神經或組織造成的傷害

20. **brain damage — 腦部損傷**

Practice 1

> The injury caused serious **brain damage**.

傷勢造成嚴重**腦部損傷**。

Practice 2

> Doctors checked for signs of brain damage.

醫生檢查是否有**腦損傷**跡象。

21. **nerve damage — 神經損傷**

Practice 1

> The condition may cause **nerve damage**.

這種疾病可能造成**神經損傷**。

Practice 2

> Nerve damage can affect movement or sensation.

神經受損可能影響活動能力或感覺。

22. **tissue damage — 組織損傷**

Practice 1

> Extreme cold can cause **tissue damage**.

極端寒冷可以造成**組織損傷**。

Practice 2

> The treatment aims to limit tissue damage.

治療旨在限制**組織受損程度**。

23. **liver / kidney / organ damage — 肝 / 腎 / 器官損傷**

Practice 1

> Excessive alcohol consumption can contribute to **liver damage**.

過量飲酒可能導致**肝臟損傷**。

Practice 2

> The doctors monitored the patient for kidney damage.

醫生監察病人是否有**腎臟損傷**。

E. ENVIRONMENTAL DAMAGE

24. **environmental damage — 環境破壞**

Practice 1

> The project could cause serious **environmental damage**.

這個項目可能造成嚴重**環境破壞**。

Practice 2

> The company was criticised for the environmental damage caused by the spill.

公司因洩漏事故造成的**環境損害**而受到批評。

MCQ-ready definition:

environmental damage = 對自然環境、生態系統、土地、水或空氣造成的傷害

25. **ecological damage — 生態破壞**

Practice 1

> The development caused long-term **ecological damage**.

開發工程造成長期**生態破壞**。

Practice 2

> Ecological damage can affect many species.

生態損害可以影響多種物種。

26. **damage the environment — 破壞環境**

Practice 1

> Industrial waste can **damage the environment**.

工業廢物可能**破壞環境**。

Practice 2

> Tourism should be managed without damaging fragile ecosystems.

旅遊業應妥善管理，避免**破壞脆弱生態系統**。

F. ABSTRACT / NON-PHYSICAL HARM

27. **damage = harm to something non-physical — 損害**

A major extension from physical harm.

Practice 1

> The argument **damaged their relationship**.

爭論**破壞了他們的關係**。

Practice 2

> Poor leadership can damage morale.

領導不善可能**打擊士氣**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****damage = 令關係、信任、聲譽、信心等抽象事物變差或變弱****

28. **damage a relationship — 破壞關係**

Practice 1

> Constant criticism can **damage a working relationship**.

不斷批評可能**破壞工作關係**。

Practice 2

> The dispute badly damaged relations between the departments.

爭議嚴重**損害了部門之間的關係**。

29. **damage trust — 損害信任**

Extremely relevant to your passage.

Practice 1

> Unfair treatment can **damage trust**.

不公平對待可能**損害信任**。

Practice 2

> Once trust is damaged, cooperation becomes harder.

一旦**信任受損**，合作就會變得更困難。

30. **damage morale — 打擊士氣**

Practice 1

> Unclear leadership **damaged staff morale**.

不清晰的領導**打擊了員工士氣**。

Practice 2

> Repeated failures can seriously damage morale.

一再失敗可能嚴重**損害士氣**。

31. **damage confidence — 損害 / 打擊信心**

Practice 1

> The mistake **damaged investor confidence**.

這個錯誤**打擊了投資者信心**。

Practice 2

> Harsh criticism can damage a young employee's confidence.

嚴厲批評可能**打擊年輕員工的自信**。

32. **damage credibility — 損害公信力 / 可信度**

Practice 1

> Inaccurate statements can **damage credibility**.

不準確的說法可能**損害可信度**。

Practice 2

> The contradiction damaged the report's credibility.

這項矛盾**削弱了報告的可信性**。

33. **damage reputation — 損害聲譽**

Practice 1

> The scandal **damaged the company's reputation**.

醜聞**損害了公司的聲譽**。

Practice 2

> One careless comment can damage a professional reputation.

一句不慎的說話可能**損害專業聲譽**。

34. **damage prospects / chances — 損害前景 / 機會**

Practice 1

> The delay could **damage the project's prospects of success**.

延誤可能**損害項目成功的前景**。

Practice 2

> Poor results damaged his chances of promotion.

表現欠佳**降低了他晉升的機會**。

35. **damage a career — 損害職業生涯**

Practice 1

> Serious misconduct can **damage someone's career**.

嚴重失當可能**損害某人的職業生涯**。

Practice 2

> The allegation damaged her career prospects.

該指控**損害了她的職業發展前景**。

G. REPUTATIONAL DAMAGE

36. **reputational damage — 聲譽損害**

A major business/legal collocation.

Practice 1

> The incident caused significant **reputational damage**.

事件造成重大**聲譽損害**。

Practice 2

> Companies often act quickly to limit reputational damage.

企業通常會迅速行動，以限制**聲譽受損程度**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****reputational damage = 對個人或機構在他人眼中的信譽、形象和評價造成的損害****

37. ****damage to reputation — 對聲譽的損害****

Practice 1

> The organisation suffered serious ****damage to its reputation****.

機構的****聲譽受到嚴重損害****。

Practice 2

> Damage to reputation may affect future business.

****聲譽受損****可能影響未來業務。

H. PSYCHOLOGICAL / EMOTIONAL DAMAGE

38. ****psychological damage — 心理傷害****

Practice 1

> Long-term bullying can cause ****psychological damage****.

長期欺凌可能造成****心理傷害****。

Practice 2

> The experience left lasting psychological damage.

這段經歷留下了長期****心理創傷 / 傷害****。

39. ****emotional damage — 情感傷害****

Practice 1

> The conflict caused significant ****emotional damage****.

衝突造成相當大的**情感傷害**。

Practice 2

> Hurtful remarks can do emotional damage.

傷人的說話可以造成**情緒上的傷害**。

I. PROFESSIONALLY DAMAGING

40. **damaging = harmful; likely to cause negative consequences — 有害的；有破壞性的**

This is the exact adjective branch in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Such conflict is professionally **damaging**.

這種衝突在專業 / 工作層面上是**有害的**。

Practice 2

> Constant blame is damaging to teamwork.

不斷互相指責對團隊合作**具有破壞性**。

Practice 3

> Poor communication can be damaging to trust.

溝通不良可能**損害信任**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****damaging = 會令某人、某事物或某種關係變差、變弱或受損的****

41. **damaging to something — 對.....有害**

Practice 1

> The behaviour is **damaging to morale**.

這種行為對士氣**有害**。

Practice 2

> Excessive conflict can be damaging to productivity.

過度衝突可能**損害生產力**。

Grammar:

> **damaging to + noun**

42. **professionally damaging — 對職業 / 專業處境造成損害**

Practice 1

> Publicly insulting a colleague can be **professionally damaging**.

公開侮辱同事可能**損害自己的專業形象和職涯**。

Practice 2

> Repeated conflict can be professionally damaging for everyone involved.

反覆衝突可能對所有相關人士的**工作關係和專業處境造成損害**。

43. **financially damaging — 造成財務損害的**

Practice 1

> The delay was **financially damaging**.

延誤造成了**財務上的損害**。

Practice 2

> Poor decisions can be financially damaging to a small firm.

錯誤決策可能對小型企業造成**嚴重財務損害**。

44. **environmentally damaging — 破壞環境的**

Practice 1

> The process is **environmentally damaging**.

這項工序**會破壞環境**。

Practice 2

> The company replaced environmentally damaging materials.

公司更換了**對環境有害的材料**。

J. DAMAGING INFORMATION / EVIDENCE

45. **damaging evidence** — 不利 / 具殺傷力的證據

Practice 1

> The investigation uncovered **damaging evidence**.

調查發現了對某方**十分不利的證據**。

Practice 2

> The damaging evidence weakened his defence.

這些**不利證據**削弱了他的辯護。

MCQ-ready definition:

damaging evidence = 會嚴重損害某人的案件、立場、聲譽或可信度的證據

46. **damaging allegations** — 具破壞性的 / 嚴重不利的指控

Practice 1

> The report contained several **damaging allegations**.

報告包含數項**嚴重不利的指控**。

Practice 2

> Damaging allegations can affect a person's reputation even before they are resolved.

****具嚴重負面影響的指控****即使尚未有定論，也可能影響一個人的聲譽。

47. ****damaging criticism — 造成負面影響的批評****

Practice 1

> The organisation faced ****damaging criticism****.

機構受到****嚴重有損形象的批評****。

Practice 2

> Public criticism proved damaging to morale.

公開批評對士氣造成了****負面損害****。

48. ****damaging disclosure / revelation — 具破壞性的披露 / 揭露****

Practice 1

> The newspaper published a ****damaging disclosure****.

報章刊登了一項對相關人士****十分不利的揭露****。

Practice 2

> The revelation was highly damaging to the organisation's reputation.

該揭露對機構聲譽造成****嚴重損害****。

K. DAMAGE AS A VERB

49. ****damage something = cause harm to it — 損害；破壞****

Practice 1

> Water ****damaged the equipment****.

水**損壞了設備**。

Practice 2

> The argument damaged their relationship.

爭論**破壞了他們的關係**。

MCQ-ready definition:

damage X = 令 X 的狀況、功能、價值、聲譽或質素變差

50. **badly / seriously damage — 嚴重損害**

Practice 1

> The storm **badly damaged** the roof.

暴風雨**嚴重損壞**了屋頂。

Practice 2

> The dispute seriously damaged trust.

爭議**嚴重損害了信任**。

51. **partially damage — 部分損壞**

Practice 1

> The machine was only **partially damaged**.

機器只是**部分受損**。

Practice 2

> Several files were partially damaged.

數個檔案**部分損毀**。

52. **damage beyond repair — 損壞至無法修復**

Practice 1

> The device was ****damaged beyond repair****.

裝置****損壞至無法修復****。

Practice 2

> Their relationship may have been damaged beyond repair.

他們的關係可能已經****破裂至無法挽回****。

Literal and figurative.

L. DAMAGED

53. ****damaged = harmed or broken — 受損的****

Practice 1

> Replace all ****damaged equipment****.

更換所有****受損設備****。

Practice 2

> Damaged files may not open correctly.

****受損檔案****可能無法正常開啟。

54. ****damaged goods — 受損貨品****

Literal commercial sense.

Practice 1

> The shop sells ****damaged goods**** at a discount.

商店以折扣價出售****受損貨品****。

Practice 2

> Damaged goods should be recorded separately.

****損壞貨品**應分開記錄。**

55. ****damaged goods = figurative description of a person — 被視為「有缺陷 / 受創」的人****

This figurative use exists but can sound demeaning.

Practice

> Describing a traumatised person as “****damaged goods****” is often offensive and dehumanising.

把受過創傷的人稱為 ****damaged goods**** 往往帶有侮辱性和物化意味。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****damaged goods = figurative, often offensive: 被視為因過往經歷而「失去價值」的人****

Learners should ****recognize it but avoid casually using it about people****.

56. ****undamaged — 未受損的 ; 完好的****

Practice 1

> Most of the equipment remained ****undamaged****.

大部分設備仍然****完好無損****。

Practice 2

> The documents were recovered undamaged.

文件被取回時****沒有受損****。

M. PREVENT / LIMIT / REPAIR DAMAGE

57. ****prevent damage — 防止損害****

Practice 1

> Regular maintenance can **prevent damage**.

定期保養可以**防止損壞**。

Practice 2

> Clear procedures help prevent reputational damage.

清晰程序有助**防止聲譽受損**。

58. **limit damage — 限制損害程度**

Practice 1

> Quick action helped **limit the damage**.

迅速行動有助**限制損害程度**。

Practice 2

> Management acted to limit damage to staff morale.

管理層採取行動，以**減低對員工士氣的損害**。

59. **minimise/minimize damage — 把損害減到最低**

Practice 1

> The emergency plan is designed to **minimise damage**.

緊急計劃旨在把**損害減至最低**。

Practice 2

> Honest communication may minimize reputational damage.

坦誠溝通可能把**聲譽損害降至最低**。

60. **repair damage — 修復損壞 / 彌補損害**

Practice 1

> Engineers worked to **repair the damage**.

工程師努力**修復損壞**。

Practice 2

> It may take years to repair the damage to trust.

要**修補受損的信任**可能需要多年。

Literal and figurative.

61. **assess the damage — 評估損害**

Practice 1

> Inspectors arrived to **assess the damage**.

檢查人員到場**評估損害情況**。

Practice 2

> Management needs to assess the reputational damage.

管理層需要**評估聲譽損害**。

62. **damage assessment — 損害評估**

Practice 1

> A full **damage assessment** will be carried out.

將會進行全面**損害評估**。

Practice 2

> The team completed a preliminary damage assessment.

團隊完成了初步**損毀評估**。

N. DAMAGE CONTROL

63. **damage control = actions taken to limit harm — 損害控制；危機補救**

Originally literal/technical, now extremely common figuratively.

Practice 1

> The company immediately began **damage control**.

公司立即開始進行**危機補救 / 損害控制**。

Practice 2

> The apology was partly an exercise in damage control.

這次道歉部分是為了**控制負面影響**。

MCQ-ready definition:

damage control = 問題已經發生後，採取措施防止損害進一步擴大

64. **do damage control — 進行危機補救**

Practice 1

> Management spent the afternoon **doing damage control**.

管理層整個下午都在**處理危機、限制損害**。

Practice 2

> The communications team was brought in to do damage control.

傳訊團隊被召來進行**危機補救工作**。

65. **damage-control exercise — 補救形象 / 限制損害的行動**

Practice 1

> The interview looked like a **damage-control exercise**.

這次訪問看來像一次**挽救形象的行動**。

Practice 2

> Critics described the announcement as damage control.

批評者把公布形容為**危機補救**。

O. DAMAGE LIMITATION

66. **damage limitation — 限制損害；減低負面後果**

Especially BrE.

Practice 1

> At this stage, the priority is **damage limitation**.

現階段的首要工作是**限制損害**。

Practice 2

> The company shifted from prevention to damage limitation.

公司由預防問題轉為**限制已造成的損害**。

MCQ-ready definition:

damage limitation = 問題已發生後，盡量控制其規模和後果

Important distinction: **damage prevention vs damage control**

damage prevention

before harm occurs:

> 防止損害發生

damage control

after harm has begun:

> 防止損害繼續擴大

This is a very useful distinction.

P. COLLATERAL DAMAGE

67. **collateral damage = unintended harm caused alongside an intended action — 附帶損害**

Originally especially military.

Practice 1

> The operation caused significant **collateral damage**.

行動造成重大**附帶損害**。

Practice 2

> Measures should be designed to minimize collateral damage.

措施應設計成盡量減少**附帶影響 / 損害**。

MCQ-ready definition:

collateral damage = 在達成另一主要目標時，非主要目的但同時造成的額外傷害或破壞

68. **collateral damage = figurative unintended negative effects — 附帶負面影響**

Practice 1

> Staff morale became **collateral damage** in the dispute between managers.

員工士氣成為經理爭議中的**附帶犧牲品 / 附帶損害**。

Practice 2

> Small suppliers may become collateral damage in a price war.

小型供應商可能成為價格戰中的**附帶受害者**。

This figurative extension is very common.

Q. LEGAL DAMAGES

69. **damages = money awarded as compensation for legal harm — 損害賠償金**

This is a completely separate and extremely important plural legal noun.

Practice 1

> The court awarded her **damages**.

法院判給她**損害賠償金**。

Practice 2

> The company was ordered to pay damages.

公司被命令支付**賠償金**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****damages = 法院或法律程序因某人受到損害而判給 / 要求支付的金錢賠償****

Critical:

> **damage** = 損害

> **damages** = **法律賠償金**

70. **claim damages — 索取損害賠償**

Practice 1

> The customer may **claim damages**.

顧客可以**索取損害賠償**。

Practice 2

> The claimant sought damages for financial loss.

申索人就財務損失**要求賠償**。

71. **seek damages — 尋求損害賠償**

Practice 1

> The company is **seeking damages** for breach of contract.

公司正因違約**追討損害賠償**。

Practice 2

> She brought a claim seeking damages.

她提出申索，要求**損害賠償**。

72. **award damages** — 判給損害賠償

Practice 1

> The court **awarded damages** to the claimant.

法院向申索人**判給損害賠償**。

Practice 2

> Damages were awarded for lost income.

法院就損失收入**判給賠償金**。

73. **pay damages** — 支付損害賠償

Practice 1

> The defendant was ordered to **pay damages**.

被告被命令**支付賠償金**。

Practice 2

> The settlement required the company to pay damages.

和解要求公司**支付損害賠償**。

R. TYPES OF LEGAL DAMAGES

74. **compensatory damages — 補償性損害賠償**

Practice 1

> The court awarded **compensatory damages**.

法院判給**補償性損害賠償**。

Practice 2

> Compensatory damages generally seek to compensate for proven loss or injury.

補償性賠償一般旨在彌補已證明的損失或傷害。

75. **punitive damages — 懲罰性損害賠償**

Especially associated with some legal systems.

Practice 1

> The claimant also sought **punitive damages**.

申索人亦要求**懲罰性賠償**。

Practice 2

> Availability of punitive damages depends on the jurisdiction and type of claim.

是否可判**懲罰性損害賠償**取決於司法管轄區和案件類型。

76. **nominal damages — 象徵性損害賠償**

Practice 1

> The court awarded **nominal damages**.

法院判給**象徵性賠償**。

Practice 2

> Nominal damages may recognise a legal wrong despite little or no proven financial loss.

即使沒有證明重大金錢損失，**象徵性賠償**仍可確認權利受到侵犯。

77. **liquidated damages — 約定損害賠償**

A major contract-law term.

Practice 1

> The contract contains a **liquidated damages clause**.

合約包含一項**約定損害賠償條款**。

Practice 2

> The clause specifies an agreed amount payable for particular breaches.

該條款訂明特定違約情況下須支付的**預定賠償金額**。

78. **damages for breach of contract — 違約損害賠償**

Practice 1

> The supplier sought **damages for breach of contract**.

供應商就違約**追討損害賠償**。

Practice 2

> The amount of damages depends on the relevant legal principles and proven loss.

賠償金額取決於相關法律原則和已證明損失。

Important distinction: **damage vs damages**

damage

uncountable noun:

> The accident caused serious **damage**.
> 事故造成嚴重**損害**。

damages

plural legal noun:

> The court awarded **damages**.
> 法院判給**賠償金**。

Never treat these as an ordinary singular/plural pair.

S. INFORMAL: WHAT'S THE DAMAGE?

79. **What's the damage? = How much does it cost? — 要多少錢？多少埋單？**

Informal/humorous.

Practice 1

> “So, **what's the damage?**”

「那麼，**總共多少錢？**」

Practice 2

> After dinner, he asked the waiter, “What's the damage?”

吃完晚飯後，他問侍應：「**埋單多少？**」

MCQ-ready definition:

What's the damage? = informal/humorous: 這東西 / 這頓飯要花多少錢？

Here **damage** humorously treats the cost as harm to your wallet.

80. **the damage = the cost/bill — 費用；埋單金額**

Practice 1

> The total damage came to \$200.

最後**埋單金額**是二百元。

Practice 2

> I was afraid to ask what the damage was.

我甚至不敢問**總共要付多少錢**。

Informal only.

T. GAMING: DAMAGE

81. **damage = amount of harm inflicted in a game — 傷害值**

A very common modern gaming sense.

Practice 1

> This weapon deals high **damage**.

這件武器的**傷害值**很高。

Practice 2

> The attack does more damage at close range.

這項攻擊在近距離造成更高**傷害**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****damage = 電子遊戲中攻擊令角色 / 敵人失去生命值或耐久度的數值****

82. **deal damage — 造成傷害**

Practice 1

> The ability **deals damage** to nearby enemies.

這項技能會對附近敵人**造成傷害**。

Practice 2

> Critical hits deal additional damage.

暴擊會**造成額外傷害**。

83. **take damage — 受到傷害**

Practice 1

> The character **takes damage** from fire.

角色會因火焰而**受到傷害**。

Practice 2

> You take less damage while blocking.

格擋時你受到的**傷害較少**。

84. **damage output — 傷害輸出**

Practice 1

> This build has very high **damage output**.

這個角色配置的**傷害輸出**非常高。

Practice 2

> The update reduced the character's damage output.

更新降低了角色的**傷害輸出**。

85. **damage per second / DPS — 每秒傷害**

Practice 1

> The weapon has high **damage per second**.

這件武器有很高的**每秒傷害**。

Practice 2

> Players often abbreviate damage per second as **DPS**.

玩家通常把 **damage per second** 簡稱為 **DPS (每秒傷害)**。

U. DAMAGE IN COMPUTING / DATA

86. **damage data/files/system — 損毀數據 / 檔案 / 系統**

Same broad harm sense, but very common digitally.

Practice 1

> Malware can **damage files**.

惡意軟件可以**損毀檔案**。

Practice 2

> Sudden power loss may damage the system.

突然斷電可能**損害系統**。

87. **damaged/corrupted file — 損毀檔案**

Practice 1

> The backup contained several **damaged files**.

備份中有數個**受損檔案**。

Practice 2

> A damaged file may be unreadable.

損毀檔案可能無法讀取。

Important distinction 1: **damage vs harm**

damage

especially natural for:

- * objects,
- * systems,
- * reputation,
- * relationships,
- * organs.

harm

broader and especially natural for:

- * people,
- * health,
- * welfare,
- * society.

Compare:

> damage the machine

> 損壞機器

> harm a child

> 傷害兒童

But overlap is large:

> environmental damage / environmental harm

Important distinction 2: **damage vs injure**

injure

normally a person/animal/body part.

damage

objects, organs, tissue, reputation, relationships, etc.

> injure a worker

> 令工人受傷

> damage a nerve

> 損傷神經

You normally do **not** say:

> *damage a person*

> for ordinary bodily injury.

Important distinction 3: **damage vs hurt**

hurt

common everyday word:

* physical pain,

* emotional pain.

damage

more formal and often implies lasting impairment.

> hurt my arm

> 手臂弄痛了

> damage a nerve

> 神經受損

Important distinction 4: **damage vs destroy**

damage

make worse but not necessarily completely unusable.

destroy

ruin completely or almost completely.

> The fire damaged the building.

> 大樓受損，可能仍存在。

> The fire destroyed the building.

> 大樓被完全摧毀。

Important distinction 5: **damage** vs **ruin**

From your earlier **ruin** family:

damage

harm to some degree.

ruin

damage so badly that usefulness, success or enjoyment is largely destroyed.

> damage a relationship

> 損害關係

> ruin a relationship

> 把關係徹底搞垮

Ruin is stronger.

Important distinction 6: **damage** vs **break**

break

cause something to crack, separate or stop functioning.

damage

broader deterioration/harm.

A phone can be damaged but still work.

A broken phone normally no longer works properly.

Important distinction 7: **damage** vs **spoil**

spoil

reduce quality/enjoyment, especially:

- * food,
- * occasion,
- * surprise,
- * appearance.

damage

more general/serious harm.

- > spoil a holiday
- > 破壞假期氣氛

- > damage a reputation
- > 損害聲譽

Important distinction 8: **damage vs impair**

impair

reduce ability/function.

damage

broader; may cause the impairment.

- > alcohol impairs judgment
- > 酒精削弱判斷力

- > injury damages the brain
- > 傷勢損害腦部

Important distinction 9: **damage vs weaken**

weaken

make less strong.

damage

cause harm more generally.

In your passage:

> conflict **damages** trust

and:

> it **weakens** trust

are closely related, but **weaken** specifically describes loss of strength.

Important distinction 10: **damage** vs **undermine**

undermine

gradually weaken:

- * confidence,
- * authority,
- * trust,
- * position.

damage

broader and can be sudden or gradual.

> undermine trust

> 逐漸削弱信任

> damage trust

> 損害信任

Important distinction 11: **damage** vs **loss**

damage

the harm itself.

loss

what is lost:

- * money,
- * property,

- * opportunity,
- * life, etc.

An accident may cause:

> property damage + financial loss.

They are related but not identical.

Important distinction 12: **damage vs wear and tear**

damage

usually identifiable harm, often accidental/event-driven.

wear and tear

gradual deterioration through normal use.

This distinction is especially common in insurance/rental contexts.

Important distinction 13: **damage is normally uncountable**

Natural:

- > serious damage ✓
- > extensive damage ✓
- > a lot of damage ✓

Usually not:

- > **a damage** ✗

For one instance/type, use:

- > an item of damage
- > an area of damage
- > a type of damage

But legal **damages** is a separate plural noun.

Important distinction 14: ****damage to X vs damage of X****

The normal pattern is:

> ****damage to something****

> damage to the roof

> damage to reputation

Not normally:

> *damage of the roof* ❌

Important distinction 15: ****do damage to vs damage****

Both work:

> The scandal ****damaged the company****.

> The scandal ****did serious damage to the company****.

The noun construction often allows stronger modification:

> did enormous damage to...

Important distinction 16: ****suffer damage vs cause damage****

****cause damage****

the damaging agent.

****suffer damage****

the affected thing.

> The storm caused damage.

> 暴風雨造成損害。

> The building suffered damage.

> 建築物受到損害。

Important distinction 17: ****sustain damage vs suffer damage****

Very close.

****suffer damage****

ordinary/formal.

****sustain damage****

somewhat formal, common in:

- * accidents,
- * buildings,
- * vehicles,
- * military reporting.

Important distinction 18: ****damaging vs damaged****

****damaging****

causes harm:

- > damaging criticism
- > 會造成傷害的批評

****damaged****

has received harm:

- > damaged reputation
- > 已受損的聲譽

Cause vs result.

Important distinction 19: ****damaging vs harmful****

****harmful****

general potential/actual negative effect.

damaging

often stresses that something harms a particular thing's:

- * condition,
- * reputation,
- * relationship,
- * prospects.

> harmful chemical

> 有害化學物

> damaging allegation

> 會嚴重損害聲譽的指控

Important distinction 20: **professionally damaging**

This can mean harm to:

- * career,
- * workplace reputation,
- * professional relationship,
- * job performance,
- * credibility.

It does **not** mean:

> “damaging something in a professional way.”

Here **professionally** means:

****in terms of someone's professional/work life****

Important distinction 21: ****reputational damage vs financial damage****

****reputational damage****

harm to how others view you.

****financial damage****

money-related harm/loss.

Reputational damage may later produce financial loss, but the two are distinct.

Important distinction 22: **psychological damage vs emotional upset**

emotional upset

temporary distress.

psychological damage

stronger and may imply more serious or lasting effects.

So use **psychological damage** carefully.

Important distinction 23: **repair physical damage vs repair reputational damage**

Physical:

- > repair a damaged roof
- > 修理受損屋頂

Figurative:

- > repair damage to trust
- > 修復受損信任

The verb **repair** extends metaphorically from objects to relationships/reputation.

Important distinction 24: **damage control vs prevention**

Again:

- > prevention = before
- > damage control = after.

A company doing **damage control** has normally already suffered some problem.

Important distinction 25: **damage control vs crisis management**

crisis management

manage the whole crisis.

damage control

specifically limit negative consequences.

Damage control is often one part of crisis management.

Important distinction 26: **collateral damage**

This does not merely mean:

> “more damage.”

It specifically means:

harm that is secondary/unintended relative to the main intended action

Hence figurative:

> morale became collateral damage.

Important distinction 27: **damage vs damages**

Critical exam distinction:

> **damage** = 損害

> **damages** = 損害賠償金

Example:

> The accident caused \$10,000 worth of **damage**.

> 事故造成價值一萬元的損害。

> The court awarded \$10,000 in **damages**.

> 法院判給一萬元賠償金。

Important distinction 28: **damages vs compensation**

compensation

broad money/payment made to compensate someone.

damages

specifically legal monetary remedy for loss/wrong.

All damages are a kind of compensation, but not all compensation is legally **damages**.

Important distinction 29: **compensatory vs punitive damages**

compensatory damages

aim to compensate loss.

punitive damages

aim additionally to punish/deter in legal systems where available.

Very different purposes.

Important distinction 30: **liquidated damages vs penalty**

liquidated damages

contractually pre-agreed sum intended to address breach-related loss.

penalty

punitive amount.

Legal enforceability and classification depend on jurisdiction, so learners should not treat them as automatic synonyms.

Important distinction 31: **what's the damage?**

This is informal and humorous.

It does ****not**** refer to physical damage.

The metaphor is:

> cost → damage to your wallet.

Avoid in very formal transactions.

Important distinction 32: ****gaming damage****

In games:

> damage

has become count-like conceptually, but English usually still treats it as mass noun:

> deal ****100 damage****

> deal ****a lot of damage****

not normally:

> ***100 damages***.

Important distinction 33: ****damage output vs output****

From your earlier ****output**** family:

****damage output****

specifically the amount/rate of combat damage produced.

****output****

general product/result of a system or worker.

Important distinction 34: ****damaged goods literal vs figurative****

Literal:

- > damaged goods
- > 受損貨品

Figurative about people:

- > can imply the person has become less valuable because of trauma/past experiences.

That metaphor can be demeaning, so recognition is useful but active use should be cautious.

Important distinction 35: **damage in your passage**

The full sentence is:

- > Such conflict is not only emotionally draining but also professionally **damaging**, because it weakens trust, which is the foundation of all effective teamwork.

The logic is:

- > interpersonal conflict
- > → weakens trust
- > → harms cooperation
- > → harms professional effectiveness

So **damaging** here means more than:

- > unpleasant.

It means:

causing actual deterioration in the team's ability to function professionally

Family-extension note

The **damage** family has several major modern branches:

1. **physical harm**

- * cause damage
- * structural damage
- * water damage

2. **bodily harm**

- * brain damage
- * tissue damage
- * nerve damage

3. **environment**

- * environmental damage
- * ecological damage

4. **abstract harm**

- * damage trust
- * damage morale
- * damage relationships

5. **reputation/career**

- * reputational damage
- * damage a career
- * professionally damaging

6. **harmful adjective**

- * damaging evidence
- * damaging criticism

7. **result adjective**

- * damaged equipment
- * damaged reputation
- * undamaged

8. **prevent/repair**

- * prevent damage
- * minimise damage
- * repair damage

9. **crisis response**

- * damage control
- * damage limitation

10. **unintended secondary harm**

* collateral damage

11. **legal compensation**

* damages

* compensatory damages

* punitive damages

* liquidated damages

12. **informal cost**

* What's the damage?

13. **gaming**

* deal damage

* take damage

* DPS

14. **digital systems**

* damaged files

* damage data

For your passage, the exact branch is:

damaging = causing deterioration in professional trust, relationships and team effectiveness

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
damage (noun)	損害 ; 破壞	harm	
cause damage	造成損害	cause	
do damage to X	對 X 造成損害	harm	
suffer damage	遭受損害	receive harm	
sustain damage	遭受損害	formal receive harm	
inflict damage	造成 / 施加損害	active harm	
minor damage	輕微損害	degree	
severe damage	嚴重損害	degree	
extensive damage	大範圍損害	scale	

permanent damage	永久損害	duration	
irreversible damage	不可逆轉損害	permanence	
irreparable damage	無法修復的損害	repairability	
structural damage	結構損壞	buildings	
property damage	財物 / 物業損害	property	
water damage	水損	cause	
fire damage	火災損害	cause	
storm damage	風災損害	cause	
accidental damage	意外損壞	insurance	
brain damage	腦部損傷	health	
nerve damage	神經損傷	health	
tissue damage	組織損傷	health	
environmental damage	環境破壞	environment	
ecological damage	生態破壞	environment	
damage a relationship	破壞關係	abstract	
damage trust	損害信任	teamwork	
damage morale	打擊士氣	teamwork	
damage confidence	打擊信心	abstract	
damage credibility	損害可信度	reputation	
damage reputation	損害聲譽	reputation	
damage prospects	損害前景	opportunity	
damage a career	損害職業生涯	career	
reputational damage	聲譽損害	reputation	
psychological damage	心理傷害	psychological	
emotional damage	情感傷害	emotional	
damaging	有害的 ; 破壞性的	causes harm	
damaging to X	對 X 有害	harmful	
professionally damaging	對專業 / 職業有害	passage sense	
financially damaging	造成財務損害的	finance	
environmentally damaging	破壞環境的	environment	
damaging evidence	不利證據	weakens position	
damaging allegation	嚴重不利指控	reputation	
damage (verb)	損害 ; 破壞	cause harm	
badly damaged	嚴重受損	degree	
damaged beyond repair	損壞至無法修復	extreme	
damaged	受損的	result	
damaged goods	受損貨品	commerce	
undamaged	未受損的	opposite	
prevent damage	防止損害	prevention	
limit damage	限制損害	control	
minimise damage	把損害降至最低	control	
repair damage	修復 / 彌補損害	recovery	
assess damage	評估損害	evaluation	
damage control	損害控制 / 危機補救	post-problem response	
damage limitation	限制損害	containment	
collateral damage	附帶損害	unintended harm	

damages	損害賠償金	legal money	
claim damages	索取賠償	law	
award damages	判給賠償	law	
pay damages	支付賠償	law	
compensatory damages	補償性賠償	law	
punitive damages	懲罰性賠償	law	
nominal damages	象徵性賠償	law	
liquidated damages	約定損害賠償	contract law	
What's the damage?	總共多少錢？	informal cost	
damage (gaming)	傷害值	game mechanic	
deal damage	造成傷害	gaming	
take damage	受到傷害	gaming	
damage output	傷害輸出	gaming	
DPS	每秒傷害	gaming	

For your original sentence

> Such conflict is not only emotionally draining but also professionally ****damaging****, because it weakens trust, which is the foundation of all effective teamwork.

Here:

****professionally damaging** = 這種衝突會實際損害員工之間的信任、工作關係、合作效率和專業環境，而不只是令人心情不好**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 這種衝突不但令人情緒疲憊，在工作層面上也****具有破壞性 / 會造成專業上的損害****，因為它會削弱信任，而信任正是所有有效團隊合作的基礎。

The cleanest learner contrast is:

- > ****harm**** = 最廣義的傷害 / 不良影響
- > ****damage**** = ****令狀況、功能、價值、關係或聲譽受損****
- > ****injure**** = 令人物理受傷
- > ****hurt**** = 令身體痛 / 感情受傷
- > ****weaken**** = 令力量或程度變弱
- > ****undermine**** = 慢慢削弱基礎、信心或權威
- > ****ruin**** = 損害到幾乎徹底失去價值 / 成功可能

And one exam-critical distinction:

- > ****damage**** = 損害，通常不可數
- > ****damages**** = ****法律上的損害賠償金****

For this teamwork paragraph specifically, ****damaging**** is best understood as *****“causing real deterioration in how effectively people can work together.”****